

Every Child Can Factsheet

The 'Every Child Can' initiative runs alongside the government's broader 10-year National Youth Strategy and the "Every Child Achieving and Thriving" white paper, which targets Special Educational Needs and Disabilities (SEND) reforms and overall system inclusivity

Every Child Can introduces a national Enrichment Framework to ensure that every child, regardless of background, has access to high-quality opportunities beyond the classroom that build confidence, skills, wellbeing and aspiration. The framework is underpinned by eight enrichment benchmarks for schools and colleges.

Synopsis of the Eight Enrichment Benchmarks

1. Strategically aligned enrichment – Enrichment should be embedded within the school's vision, linked to priorities such as attendance, attainment, personal development and careers, and supported by leadership.
2. A broad and well-rounded offer – Every young person should have access to opportunities across five key areas:
 - Arts and culture
 - Sport and physical activity
 - Nature, outdoors and adventure
 - Civic engagement
 - Wider life and future skills (including STEM, financial capability and digital skills).
3. Well-communicated and celebrated – Schools should clearly promote opportunities, encourage participation and recognise pupils' achievements.
4. Shaped by the school community – Enrichment should be designed with input from pupils, parents, staff and local communities, ensuring it reflects local needs and interests.
5. Accessible and inclusive – Activities should be available to all children, with barriers to participation removed, particularly for disadvantaged pupils, those with SEND and other underrepresented groups.

6. Built on partnerships – Schools should work collaboratively with employers, voluntary organisations, youth providers, cultural organisations, sports clubs and community groups to broaden opportunities.
7. Outcomes-focused – Schools should monitor participation and evaluate the impact of enrichment on confidence, wellbeing, belonging, employability skills and personal development.
8. Continuously improving – Schools should regularly review their offer, gather feedback, identify gaps and refine provision to ensure continuous improvement.

The framework is intended to make enrichment a core entitlement, rather than an optional extra, helping to reduce inequalities in access while better preparing young people for education, employment and life.

It is supported by the Government's £132.5 million Every Child Can programme, which aims to expand enrichment opportunities both in schools and through community and holiday provision.



Read the DWP Press Release Here:

[Every child to get access to enriching activities to build skills and confidence for life - GOV.UK](#)